Moro reflex



Newborn exhibiting Moro reflex

It is elicited by raising the shoulder for 45° from ground and then dropping by 30°. There will be abduction and extension of arms with opening of fingers. This is followed by flexion and adduction of arms.

Palmar Grasp reflex



Eliciting Palmar grasp

It is elicited by touching the baby's palm from the ulnar side with finger or any other suitable object. The fingers close and grasp the object.

8.2 Medical and Special Care of Newborn

The first week of life is the most crucial period in the life of an infant. In India, 61.3 percent of all infant deaths occur within the first month of life. Of these, more than half may die during first week of birth. This is because the newborn has to adapt itself rapidly and successfully to an alien external environment. The risk of death is the greatest during the first 24-48 hours after birth.

Principles of Newborn care

- To promote adequate oxygenation
- To prevent hypothermia
- To promote early breastfeeding
- To prevent neonatal infections
- To identify at risk newborn
- To facilitate stabilization of the newborn

HJLQVZ

Care of newborn

Maintenance of normal respiration and oxygenation

The first cry of the baby after birth is the sign of respiration. All babies should cry immediately after birth. If the baby doesn't cry, it needs immediate attention of the health care personnel. As soon as the baby is born, the airway should be cleared of mucus and any other secretions within the labour room. Then continuous monitoring of respiration and heart rate is done for every 15 minutes for first 2 hours or till adaptation to external environment. Positioning the baby with its head extended may help in the drainage of secretions. A gentle suction in the mouth first and nostrils second can facilitate removal of secretions and amniotic fluid. Resuscitation is necessary for babies who do not breathe within a minute.

The **APGAR** score is taken at 1 minute and again at 5 minutes after birth. It requires immediate and careful observation of the Appearance, Pulse, Grimace, Activity and Respiration. Each sign is given a score of 0, 1 or 2. It provides an immediate estimate of the physical condition of the baby. A perfect score should be 9 or 10. A score below 5 needs prompt action.

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